

Main

Report Name (Org_Country_Year_Report Type)

FCDE_Uganda_2022-23_3-month report

Fellowship Organization

Foundation for Community Development and Empowerment (FCDE)

Fellowship City

Kampala

Fellowship Country

Uganda

Fellowship Start Date

08/08/2022

Anticipated Fellowship End Date

08/08/2023

What is your fellowship title/role?

Community Development Fellow

What are your primary responsibilities?

Identify local partners to work with based on needs from capacity gap workplans
 Work with the Grants Committee on FCDE's grantmaking and review process
 Support FCDE on written material for communication channels
 Work with Project Directors to identify Local Partner Organizations (LPOs) to work with and the kind of support I can offer
 Foster relationships with NGOs/other potential partners in Kampala, including possible donors
 Research donor trends and identify alignment with LPO missions.

I receive adequate direction and support to perform my fellowship responsibilities.

Agree

Did you receive any sort of orientation, handover or onboarding when you started your fellowship?

Yes

Please describe your orientation/onboarding and note who handled it.

Orientation included meetings with all staff to get to know them better, meetings to understand policy, detailing my role

If you did not receive any kind of orientation, what information or guidance were you provided at the start of your fellowship?
Describe a representative day at work.

Check in with supervisors, check in with LPOs, search for funding opportunities and help on current applications, review written materials for communications, help FCDE apply to grants, meet with current/potential partners in Kampala occasionally

On average, how many hours per week do you work?

40

How would you describe your effectiveness in your fellowship post so far?

Effective

Please briefly describe 1-2 specific projects that you have undertaken or accomplishments you have made so far.

-Conducted research for and helped write a proposal for FCDE to acquire funding from the Arcus Foundation, which works with LGBT initiatives, an area FCDE wants to explore contributing to in western Uganda
 -Creating a database of funders for LPOs and creating a fundraising policy so that they can find and apply for opportunities easier in the future

What is your organization's work culture like?
What is your office environment like? Please comment on the size and structure of the office(s) where you do most of your work.

I work remotely from Kampala in my apartment

To whom do you report?

Country Director, Program Director, and another Program Director

Have you had an initial check-in with your supervisor to set up a work plan and to set goals for your work during your fellowship year?

Yes

Was this meeting helpful in understanding your role and setting goals for your fellowship year?

Yes

Please explain why you have not met with your supervisor and if you have plans to do so going forward.
Please briefly indicate 3-5 professional goals you have for the rest of your fellowship year. Your professional goals should align with your work plan.

-Understand the fundraising and proposal process from the perspective of a local grassroots organization
 -Build my networking skills in Uganda
 -Work on communications skills in a small organization
 -Help local partner organizations grow and gain skills

Do you receive adequate direction/support to perform your fellowship responsibilities?
Please provide more information on your response above.

I have experience working in international development with larger NGOs and agencies, but wanted to get a complete picture by working closer to the implementation side with an in-country local grassroots team

How often do you check in with your supervisor?

Weekly

Have you had an opportunity to travel for work so far?

No, but it has been discussed

Describe this travel opportunity. Include location(s) and a brief description of the purpose of the trip(s).

I feel adequately prepared for my position's professional responsibilities.

Agree

Please briefly explain your response.

I feel prepared for the kind of work I am doing, but have room to grow in understanding processes with capacity building at this size of an organization

Life at Fellowship Site

How did you travel to your host country and site? Please be specific

Flight from Washington, D.C. to Entebbe on Qatar Airways through Doha - \$692.45

Flight from Zanzibar to Washington, D.C. on Qatar Airways through Doha - \$2055.38

What kind of visa/ permit do you have or applied for?

12 month work visa (only received 6 month nonwork visa)

How did you obtain (or are obtaining) your visa or permit?

On Uganda's online visa portal

Did you apply for and receive your visa / permit before heading to your host country or after arriving?

Before

What costs were associated with obtaining your visa or permit?

\$100

Did you pay the visa / permit costs or were they covered by your organization?

Covered by PiAf through the Labouisse Fellowship

Are you still having challenges obtaining your visa/ permit?

No

If yes, please explain further

g) Do you have any suggestions to help future Fellows navigate the visa / permit application process?

It is a quick process, but start early to make sure you have the necessary documents (like a police clearance)

What vaccinations were you required to obtain prior to your departure? How much did your vaccinations cost? Did you get a yellow fever vaccination?

Yellow Fever, Hep A, Polio, Tetanus, Typhoid, Meningitis. Most covered by insurance, but I got the rabies vaccine (not required) which cost around \$1000

How was your arrival and first week in your host country? Any improvements that could streamline the assimilation process for future Fellows?

FCDE sent a couple staff members to welcome me and stay with me to help get me settled in. This was very helpful as I am across the country from them normally

Is housing provided by and/or paid for by your organization? Please explain.

Paid for by my organization. I believe it costs around \$500 a month

Do you live in a location that is more urban or rural?

Somewhat Urban (Suburban)

Please describe your living environment

Feels safe, but there are frequent power outages which can be very frustrating

How do you typically travel between your home and your work? How much does your daily transportation cost and how long is your commute?

No commute due to remote work

If you live in a more rural area, what are the closest urban areas you can travel to for shopping, airport, larger medical centers, etc.?

Not in rural area

How is the weather in your host country? What season are you presently in?

Around 75F year round, currently in the rainy season until December

What is the appropriate clothing for work and outside of work at your fellowship post and in your community in general?

Collared shirt for men, dresses below the knees for women. In the community pants are typically worn by men except for on weekends or hot days when shorts are starting to be more acceptable

How have you been spending your free time?

Tourist sites, meeting up with friends at cafes, watching soccer at bars, seeing live music

I've been able to successfully navigate my personal/social life both back at home and at my fellowship post.

Agree

Please briefly explain your response below.

I have been intentional about expanding my comfort zone socially here and about making time for calls back home

Would you say you live and work in a safe area?

I'd say Kira, where I live, is a safe area. Not a lot of crime that I hear of aside from pickpocketing wallets and phones

What precautions do you take to ensure your safety?

I don't use my phone in public or crowded areas, and I keep my wallet and other belongings secured and close to my body

What has been your experience with crime so far? (Please note that any security or safety concerns or incidents should be reported directly to PiAf staff per PiAf safety and security protocol.)

Not many incidences that are close to me. Hear of some kidnappings, but those are very far away.

Describe the incidence of crime and the general security situation within your city/town. Could you recommend specific areas future Fellows might consider for safe housing? What about areas that should be avoided?

Kira is safe, but I'd recommend an area closer to the city. Naguru, Kololo (very expensive), Bukoto, Ntinda, Nakasero, Bugolobi, and Muyenga are the areas I'd recommend.

Please refer back to the goals you set for yourself before orientation. Are you working towards these goals? Have you met any of them? Changed any of them? Please explain.

It is harder for me to understand the implementation side of what I do because I am not in Kasere or Rukungiri where the work is being done. Other than that I'd say I'm meeting my other goals and expanding in the areas of fundraising and networking

Do you have any frustrations with your living arrangements, your work or your life outside of work?

The distance from any banks and the electricity struggles have been very frustrating

Has there been anything that you have needed but have not been able to locate or acquire?

N/A

How have you dealt with "culture shock"?

I'd say I've dealt with it well. Once I was able to get a feel for traveling around the city and know where I'd feel safe, It's been easier. A lot of people I meet outside of work tend to have different values from me on issues that are important to me (like being more traditional on gender roles or LGBT rights), but it's also part of the learning experience

What about your experience thus far has been the most...surprising?

The use of cash over cards is something I didn't expect and probably should have looked into earlier

What about your experience thus far has been the most...challenging?

Frequent power outages have made work very challenging. Often I am having to work extra at night or on weekends to make up for it.

What are the top 3 things you miss the most from your home country or the U.S.?

- variety of food
- consistent electricity
- raised desk (better for my neck issues)

What are the top 3 things about life in your host country that beat out life in your home country or the U.S.?

- natural beauty of the city which can be very therapeutic
- pace of life
- easy to make friends (much friendlier culture than on the east coast and everyone is a big soccer fan like me)

How is your stipend being paid?

- a. Monthly
- b. in USD
- c. US account

How are you receiving your stipend funds?

Wire

Did you raise funds to cover part of your fellowship expenses?

N/A

Please list any additional one-time or infrequent expenses not included in your monthly budget below.

Monthly Budget

Rent	Utilities	Furnishings	Phone	Home Security	Internet
\$500.00	\$30.00	\$0.00	\$15.00	\$0.00	\$95.00
Transportation	Fitness	Entertainment	Groceries	House Cleaning	Eating Out
\$110.00	\$0.00	\$40.00	\$50.00	\$0.00	\$250.00
Medications	Additional Health Insurance	Travel	Laundry	Other	Total Monthly Budget (Minus Entertainment & Travel)
\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$12.00	\$0.00	1197.00
Specify "Other"					

Final Thoughts

PiAf's orientation was sufficient in preparing me to transition into my fellowship.

Agree

Please briefly explain your response about Orientation.

Everything that I needed to reference or had questions on could easily be referenced in the orientation materials

Is there anything in particular that PiAf could cover at orientation that would have better prepared you for your fellowship post? Please specify.

In my case, working remotely in a different country has been a big adjustment. I am going back to DC in January due to the difficulties, but it may be helpful for there to be some kind of advice for fellows that may do this in the future.

As we plan the upcoming PiAf Retreat, we hope to incorporate some Fellow suggestions into our programming. What are some topics or sessions you would like to see at the Retreat? (We appreciate your feedback however, we may not be able to accommodate all suggestions or requests this year.)

I've had some issues in terms of adjusting to different values here than what I'm used to in the US. This was covered in orientation, but could be helpful to circle back to it now that we are all in country. Also would like to discuss opportunities after the fellowship is over and understand the help PiAf provides etc.